2026-2027 LPSS DRESS CODE GUIDELINES FOR STUDENTS

In accordance with **La. R.S. 17:416.7**, the Lafayette Parish School Board has adopted a standard dress code as described below. The guidelines are designed to:

- Promote school safety
- Minimize distractions and disruptions based on personal appearance, grooming, hygiene, and attire.
- Prevent clothing, jewelry, and general appearance that are health or safety hazards.
- Prevent clothing styles that are suggestive, indecent, or inappropriately fitted.
- Foster an attitude of respect for authority, improve morale, and prepare students to enter a workforce that often has rules regarding dress, conduct, and appearance.

When it is determined that a student's clothing does not comply with the dress code, a parent/legal guardian shall be asked to bring an appropriate change of clothes to school. While awaiting the change of clothes, the student may be required to (a) wait in the office; (b) attend ISS; (c) go to class; or (d) any other option deemed necessary or appropriate by an administrator. Those who fail to comply or repeatedly violate the district dress code shall be subject to disciplinary action. Clarification regarding the discipline for improper dress should be directed to the school administrator.

VERIFY UNIFORMS

Parents should not rely on stores for information regarding Lafayette Parish uniform policy. If a parent is uncertain, please refer to the district or your child's school website before purchasing.

GENERAL GUIDELINES

Fit-

- A student's clothing should not be excessively tight or large.
- Parents should buy clothing that fits appropriately and can be worn without exposing undergarments.
- Clothing should have no exaggerated fit, which would promote sagging.
- Clothes so small or modified that mid-drifts are exposed are not allowed.

Style-

- A student's clothing should be free from holes, frayed edges, or tears.
- Clothing should not be see-through.

Content-

- No clothing should contain anything that would be offensive in nature to any population of students. Clothing may not promote anything LPSS discipline policy prohibits (tobacco, alcohol, drugs, and violence).
- Clothing or grooming that is distracting to the educational environment will not be permitted.

School Spirit Attire-

- All clothing worn must represent the school the student is currently enrolled in and attending.
- Students may not wear clothing from any other public, private, or parochial school.
- Students can purchase and wear school-issued and designated school spirit attire (t-shirts) instead of the standard uniform polo shirt as a student option for daily wear (Monday-Friday).
- Only Elementary Schools may sell hooded school spirit attire garments to be worn over uniforms or spirit shirts.

Final Decision-

- The Principal or their designee shall have the final decision on all dress code regulations, appropriate fit, and style within the established guidelines as approved by the Board.

PRINCIPAL'S DISCRETION TO MAKE UNIFORM EXCEPTIONS

Principals may declare spirit days and allow students to wear school spirit shirts or dress-up days (such as when school pictures are scheduled). Principals may determine guidelines for belts and the tucking of shirts. Principals may also allow students to wear other uniforms such as Boy Scouts, Girl Scouts, band, chorus, etc. Additional questions about uniforms should be referred first to the school principal. The superintendent must approve special dress days, where fundraising monies are collected.

DRESS CODE IN SPECIAL CLASSES

Students must follow the rules of appropriate dress as dictated by the needs of special classes (i.e., physical education, industrial arts, consumer science, etc.)

EXCEPTIONS FOR RELIGIOUS REASONS

Requests for religious exceptions to the dress code must be made to the Office of Child Welfare & Attendance, which will explore the basis for the exception and determine if the exception is warranted. An individual requesting an exception bears the burden of demonstrating the following:

- The individual's legitimate religious belief conflicts with the Lafayette Parish School System student dress code.
- The dress or grooming of the student is a documented expression of their religious belief.
- The dress or grooming beliefs are rooted in religion and required by their religious practice.
- The individual has sincerely held the belief that enforcement of the student dress code will have a coercive effect that will operate to prevent their exercise of those religious beliefs.

Any student requesting an exception from the student uniform dress code for religious reasons must produce to the Office of Child Welfare and Attendance documentation establishing the legitimate existence of the religion and evidence of the grooming or dress as rooted in religion and as necessary while in school. The Office of Child Welfare and Attendance may deny a request if, in their

judgment, the requested exception poses a danger to the student requesting the exception or to any student attending school in the system. All requests for exceptions must be made prior to any actions that would otherwise be a violation of the student uniform dress code.

IDENTIFICATION

School IDs must always be visible while on campus, with the picture facing outward. They must be worn on a lanyard around the neck or clipped to the shirt collar. IDs must have the national suicide hotline phone number "988" printed on them in accordance with **La. R.S. 17:282.4**. Photos may not be covered or defaced to prevent identification.

INSIGNIA

Any combination of clothing and jewelry that law enforcement agencies currently consider gang-related is not permitted. Discriminatory, obscene, or drug/alcohol related emblems, logos, symbols, jewelry signs, speech, or literature that is discriminatory, inflammatory, or derogatory toward any sex, race, nationality, creed, political or philosophical group, is obscene or contains profanity, or makes reference to drugs, alcohol, and tobacco are not permitted.

BOOK BAGS/PURSES/LUNCH BAGS



Elementary (PreK-5th)
Parents are encouraged to have at least one set of long uniform pants for students for inclement and cold weather.

Shirts	Bottoms	Shoes/Tights/Socks
Allowed ● A collared polo-style shirt with short or long sleeves only in red, white, or navy blue ● Polo-style or uniform-style dresses in red, white, or navy blue ● Students can purchase and wear school-issued and designated school spirit attire (t-shirts) instead of the standard uniform polo shirt as a student option for daily wear (Monday-Friday) **Not Allowed** ● Large emblems, logos, or decorations ● Collarless polo-style shirts ● Sleeveless polo-style shirts ● Colors other than solid red, white, or navy blue	**Allowed** ● Pants and slacks (khaki, black, or navy blue) or jeans (blue, black, or khaki) are allowable attire ● Boys-uniform style pants or shorts ● Girls-uniform style pants, shorts, capris, skirts, skorts, or jumpers ● All bottoms must fit at the waist **Not Allowed** ● Cargo pockets ● Sagging or fitting below the waist ● Visible undergarments or any part of the midsection ● Gym shorts, leggings, jeggings, joggers, and sweatpants ● Shorts, skirts, skorts, and jumpers shorter than 4 inches above the knee ● Spandex pants or shorts, 'cut offs', and shorts or pants with holes, or frayed/fringed or unhemmed pants.	**Allowed** ● Shoes must be matching and worn at all times ● Non-skid/tennis shoes are preferable ● Closed-toe, boots, and closed-back shoes ● Socks are required ● Socks and tights must be school appropriate **Not Allowed** ● Open-toe or open-back, heeled shoes, sandals, slingbacks, slides, flip-flops, slippers, crocs, or foam runner style ● Shoes with wheels, noisemakers, and hanging tags that pose a safety concern

HEADWEAR/JEWELRY/BODY DECORATIONS

Allowed

- School-appropriate knit caps, sweatbands, and earmuffs may be worn outside only
- Stud earrings and belts
- Nails up to ¼ inch

Not Allowed

- Any type of hood, hat, or brimmed caps worn in the building or bus
- No sunglasses inside excluding transition glasses; no smart glasses
- Bandanas, bandana wraps, or any bandana prints
- Painted faces or other distracting makeup
- Hanging or dangling earrings
- Tongue, nose, or other piercings
- Offensive or vulgar tattoos (permanent or temporary) must be covered at all times
- Oversized belt buckles that present a safety concern (i.e., large buckles with spikes, rivets, brads, or any other design/size that may pose a safety concern)

Middle School (6-8 Grade)/High School (9-12 Grade)
Parents are encouraged to have at least one set of long uniform pants for students for inclement and cold weather.

Shirts

Allowed

- A collared polo-style shirt with short or long sleeves only in the assigned colors listed (See Solid Colored Shirts section below)
- Students can purchase and wear school-issued and designated school spirit attire (t-shirts) instead of the standard uniform polo shirt as a student option for daily wear (Monday-Friday)
- School extracurricular activities, clubs, and sports t-shirts may be worn on designated days as set forth by the school administrator

Not Allowed

- Large emblems, logos, or decorations
- Collarless polo-style shirts
- Sleeveless polo-style shirts
- Colors other than those designated below (See Solid Colored Shirts section below)

Solid Colored Shirts-

- Middle School-(including David Thibodaux Stem 6-8) solid red, white, or navy blue
- High School-
  - Acadiana High-solid Forest green
  - Carencro High-solid navy
  - David Thibodaux STEM Magnet Academy-solid royal blue or black (9-12 grade)
  - E. J. Sam-school-specific t-shirt purchased at school
  - Lafayette High-solid black
  - Lerosen-specific t-shirt purchased at school
  - Northside High-solid red
  - Ovey Comeaux High-solid navy
  - Southside High-solid gray
  - Early College Academy-follows the dress code of South Louisiana Community College

Bottoms

Allowed

- Pants and slacks (khaki, black, or navy blue) or jeans (blue, black, or khaki) are allowable attire
- Boys-uniform style pants or shorts
- Girls-uniform style pants, shorts, capris, skirts, skorts, or jumpers
- All bottoms must fit at the waist

Not Allowed

- Cargo pockets
- Sagging
- Fitting below the waist
- Visible undergarments or any part of the midsection
- Gym shorts, leggings, jeggings, joggers, sweatpants
- Shorts, skirts, skorts, and jumpers shorter than 4 inches above the knee
- Spandex pants or shorts, 'cut offs', and shorts or pants with holes, or frayed/fringed or unhemmed pants.

GROOMING

A student will use appropriate grooming that does not present a safety hazard or have the potential to create a campus disruption. Extremes in hairstyles that are deemed distracting to the learning environment are not permitted.

Middle School-

- Color must naturally occur on people, including the color of extensions and highlights.

High School-

- There is no restriction on hair color.

Shoes/Tights/Socks

Allowed

- Shoes must be matching and worn at all times
- Non-skid/tennis shoes are preferable
- Closed-toe and closed-back shoes
- Socks are required
- Socks and tights must be school-appropriate

Not Allowed

- Open-toe or open-back
- Sandals, slingbacks, slides, flip-flops, slippers, crocs, or foam runner style
- Shoes with wheels, noisemakers, and hanging tags that pose a safety concern

HEADWEAR/JEWELRY/BODY DECORATIONS

Allowed

- School appropriate knit caps, sweatbands, and earmuffs may be worn outside only
- Belts

Middle School-

- Earring up to the size of a quarter, nose piercing
- Nails up to ¼ inch

High School-

- Earrings, tongue, nose, or other piercings
- Reasonable Acrylic Nails

Not Allowed

Middle/High School-

- Painted faces or other distracting makeup
- Tongue or other piercings (middle school only)
- Offensive or vulgar tattoos (permanent or temporary) must be covered at all times
- Oversized belt buckles that present a safety concern (i.e., large buckles with spikes, rivets, brads, or any other design/size that may pose a safety concern
- Any type of hood, hat, or brimmed caps in the building or bus
- Bandanas, bandana wraps, or any bandana prints
- No sunglasses inside excluding transition glasses; no smart glasses

JACKETS/COATS/SWEATERS/SWEATSHIRTS PreK-12th Grade

Jackets/Coats/Sweaters-clothing that unzips or unbuttons all the way (any color).
Sweater/Sweatshirt- any clothing pulled over the head (as defined below).

Allowed

- A jacket or coat of any color or print.
  - Pre K-5th grade may wear hooded jackets or coats.
  - 6th-12th grades shall wear hoodless jackets or coats.
- Sweaters/sweatshirts (see right for approved colors)
  - Pre K-5th grade may wear hooded sweaters/sweatshirts.
  - 6th-12th grades shall wear hoodless sweaters/sweatshirts.
- Uniform shirts or approved school spirit shirts must be worn under jackets, coats, sweaters, and sweatshirts.
- Schools are permitted to sell approved hoodless school spirit attire

Not Allowed

- 6th - 12th grade may not wear hoods on any type of jacket, coat, sweater, or sweatshirt.
- Blankets, snuggies, onesies, etc..
- Hoodless garments representing any other public, private, or parochial school.
- Button-up shirts may not be worn on top of uniform shirts or spirit wear.

Sweatshirts/Sweaters

- PreK-8th (David Thibodaux STEM 6-8) solid red, white, navy blue, black, or gray.
- 9th - 12th High School solid color options, in addition to Community College and University Sweatshirts:
  - o Acadiana High-forest green, gray, black, or white
  - o Carencro High-navy, yellow gold, white, or gray
  - o David Thibodaux STEM Magnet Academy (9-12)-royal blue, gray, black, or white
  - o E. J. Sam-purple, gray, black, or white
  - o Lerosen-navy, gray, black, or white
  - o Lafayette High-kelly green, gray, black, or white
  - o Northside High-red, gray, black, or white
  - o Ovey Comeaux High-red, navy, gray, or white
  - o Southside High-navy, teal, gray, or white

GROOMING

A student will use appropriate grooming that does not present a safety hazard or have the potential to create a campus disruption. Extremes in hairstyles that are deemed distracting to the learning environment are not permitted.

EXTENUATING WEATHER CIRCUMSTANCES

Sweatpants may be worn, at the discretion of the Superintendent, when extenuating weather circumstances arise. The Superintendent will make the determination of such extenuating weather circumstances where sweatpants are allowable.